

No-Show Analysis Report

What drives patients to miss their medical appointments

1. Headline finding

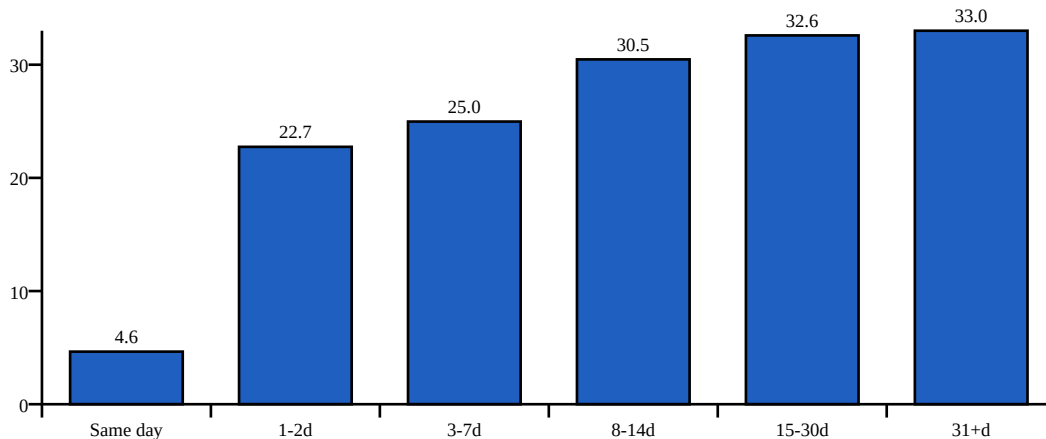
Out of 110,527 scheduled appointments, **22,319 were no-shows (20.2%)** and 88,208 were attended (79.8%). Roughly one in five patients does not turn up.

2. Waiting time between booking and appointment

Lead time is the number of days between the ScheduledDay and the AppointmentDay. The average lead time is 10.2 days, the median is 4 days and the maximum is 179 days. Appointments booked for the **same day** have a no-show rate of only **4.6%**, while the longer the wait the more likely the patient is to miss the appointment.

Lead time	Appointments	No-show rate
Booked after appointment date (data error)	5	100.0%
Same day	38,563	4.6%
1-2 days	11,938	22.7%
3-7 days	20,247	25.0%
8-14 days	12,025	30.5%
15-30 days	17,371	32.6%
31+ days	10,378	33.0%

No-show rate (%) by lead time



3. SMS reminders

SMS received	Appointments	No-shows	No-show rate
No	75,045	12,535	16.7%
Yes	35,482	9,784	27.6%

Counter-intuitively, patients who received an SMS reminder missed **more** appointments (27.6%) than patients who did not (16.7%). This does not mean SMS causes no-shows: reminders are mostly sent for appointments booked well in advance, and those appointments are inherently more likely to be missed. Same-day appointments received an SMS in 0.0% of cases (0 of them).

4. Welfare programme (Scholarship)

Scholarship (Bolsa Família)	Appointments	No-show rate
Not enrolled	99,666	19.8%
Enrolled	10,861	23.7%

Patients enrolled in the welfare programme miss appointments more often (23.7% vs 19.8%), which may reflect transport or work-related barriers.

5. Factors with little effect

- **Gender:** female 20.3% vs male 20.0%.
- **Alcoholism:** 20.1% with the condition vs 20.2% without.

6. Key takeaways

- About 20.2% of appointments end in a no-show.
- Lead time is the strongest factor seen in this data: same-day bookings are rarely missed; long waits are missed far more often.
- Younger patients and welfare-programme patients are at higher risk.
- Patients with hypertension or diabetes, who are typically older, attend more reliably.
- SMS reminders show a higher raw no-show rate, which largely reflects that they go to appointments booked further ahead.